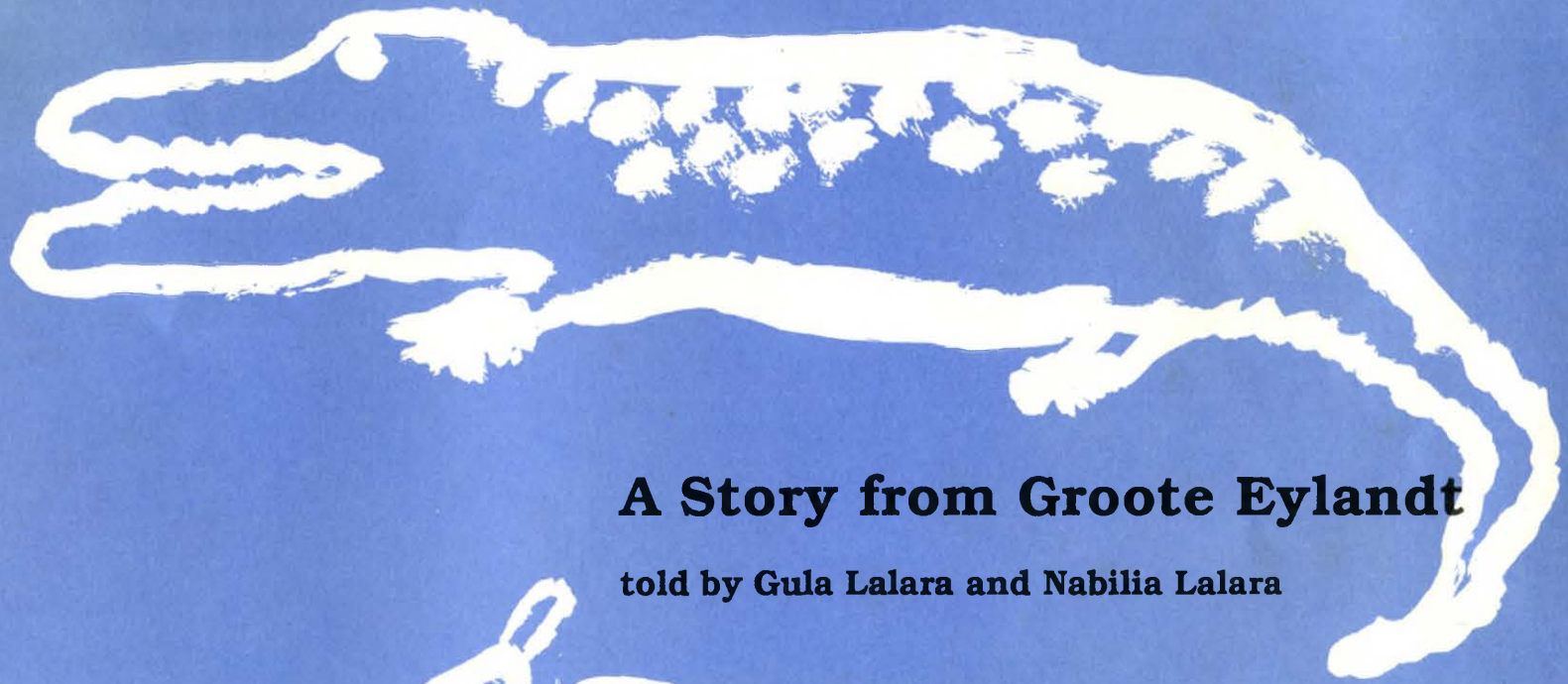
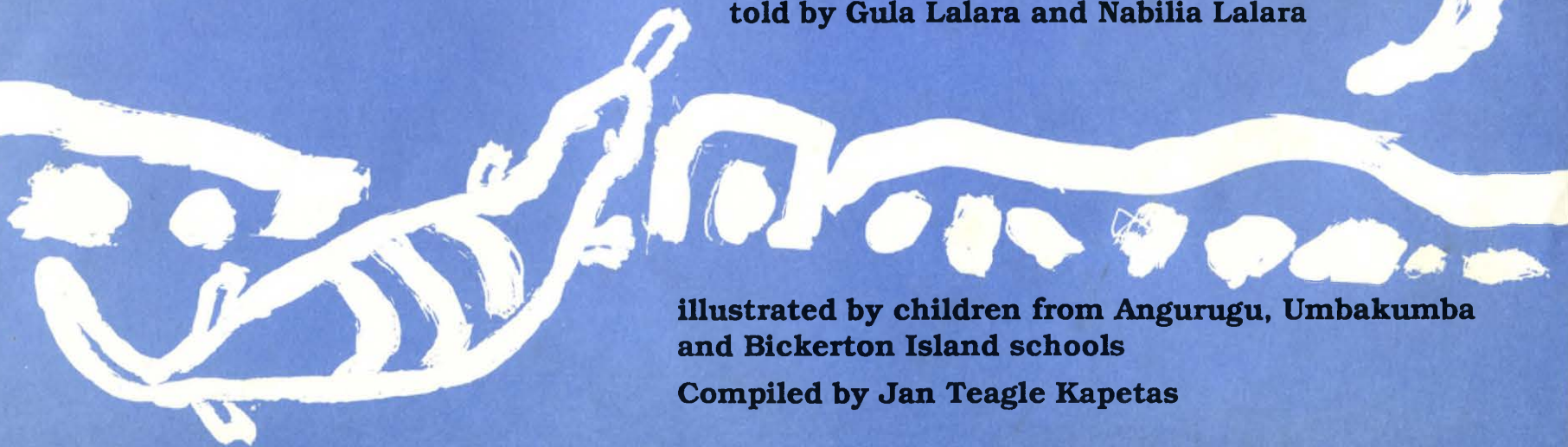


# **Crocodile and Blue Tongue Lizard**



## **A Story from Groote Eylandt**

told by Gula Lalara and Nabilia Lalara



illustrated by children from Angurugu, Umbakumba  
and Bickerton Island schools

Compiled by Jan Teagle Kapetas

**This story is told by the Aboriginal people of Groote Eylandt at Angurugu, Umbakumba and Bickerton Island. It was told in the Anindilyakwa language by Gula Lalara and Nabilia Lalara and translated into English by Dugururru Lalara assisted by Julie Waddy.**

**The illustrations are based on paintings of the story done by the children at Angurugu, Umbakumba and Bickerton Island Schools.**

**The book was compiled by Jan Teagle Kapetas for the Angurugu Community Education Centre with funding assistance from the Commonwealth Specific Purpose Grants Country Areas Program.**

**Dugururru Lalara's work was funded by the Commonwealth National Aboriginal Languages Program (1988) and the Australian Institute of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Studies (1992).**

**The original story remains the property of the Anindilyakwa people.**

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# **A Story from Groote Eylandt**

**told by Gula Lalara and Nabilia Lalara**

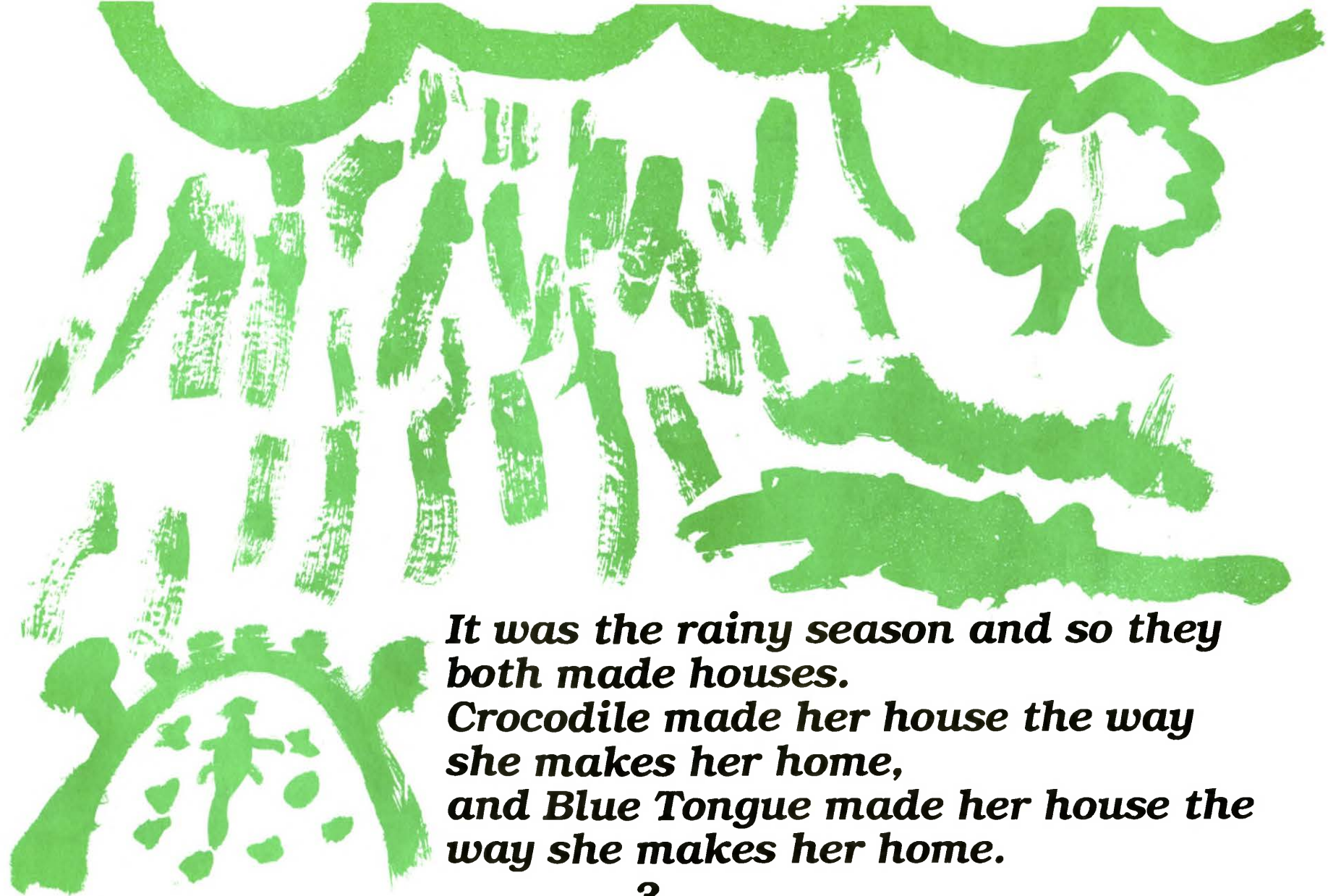
**English text adapted from a translation by Dugurru Lalara**

**Compiled by Jan Teagle Kapetas**

***A long time ago in the Dreamtime***

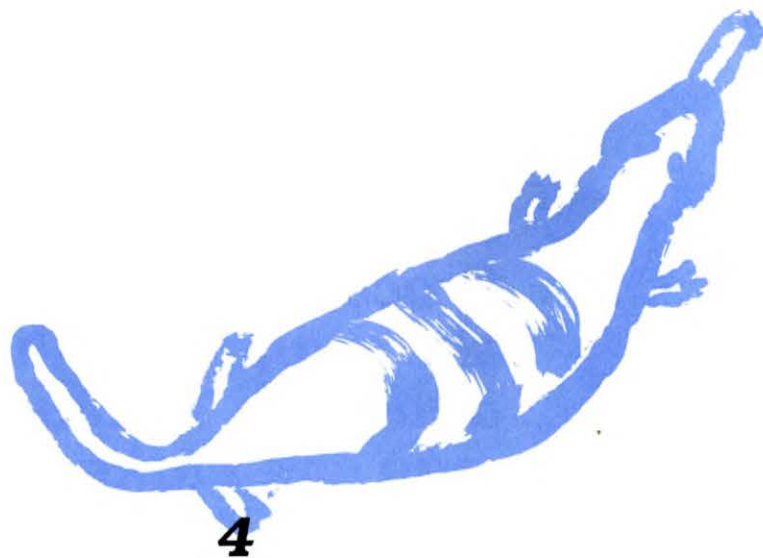
***Crocodile and Blue Tongue  
both made houses.***





*It was the rainy season and so they  
both made houses.  
Crocodile made her house the way  
she makes her home,  
and Blue Tongue made her house the  
way she makes her home.*

***Then they both went out hunting for food.***





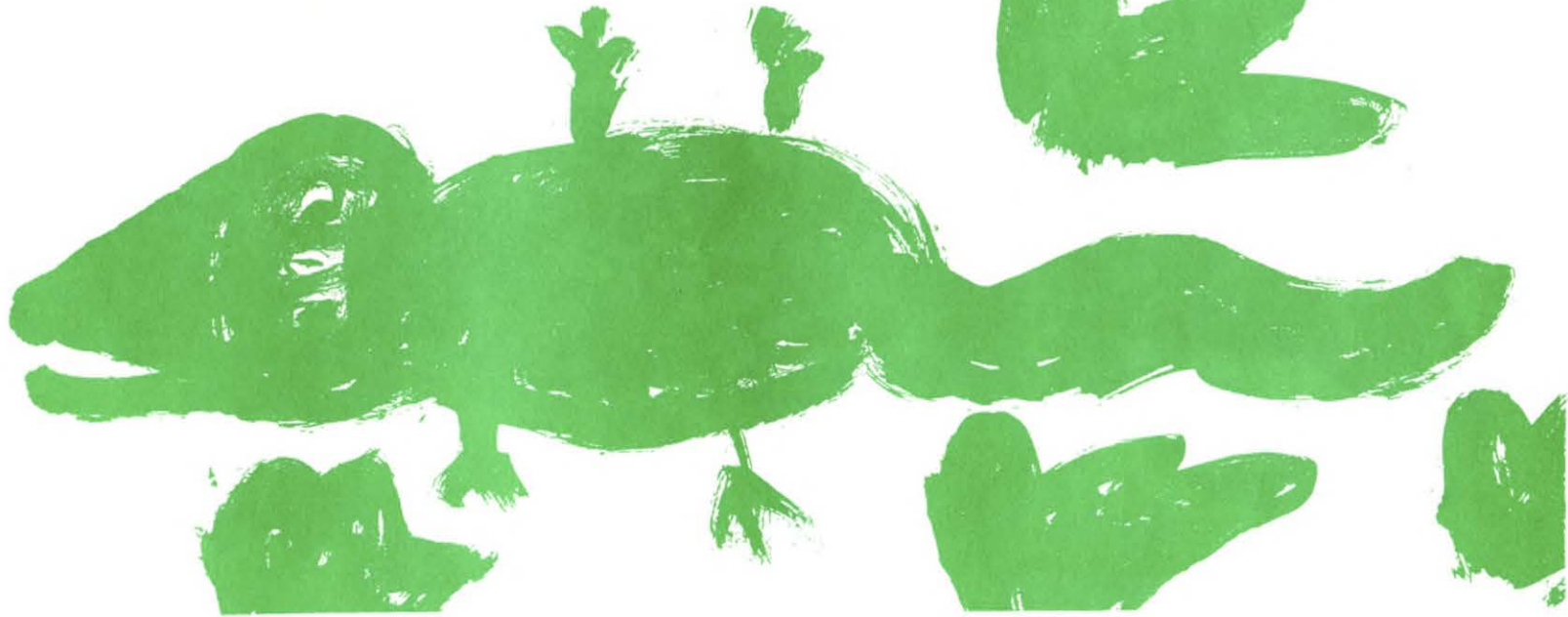




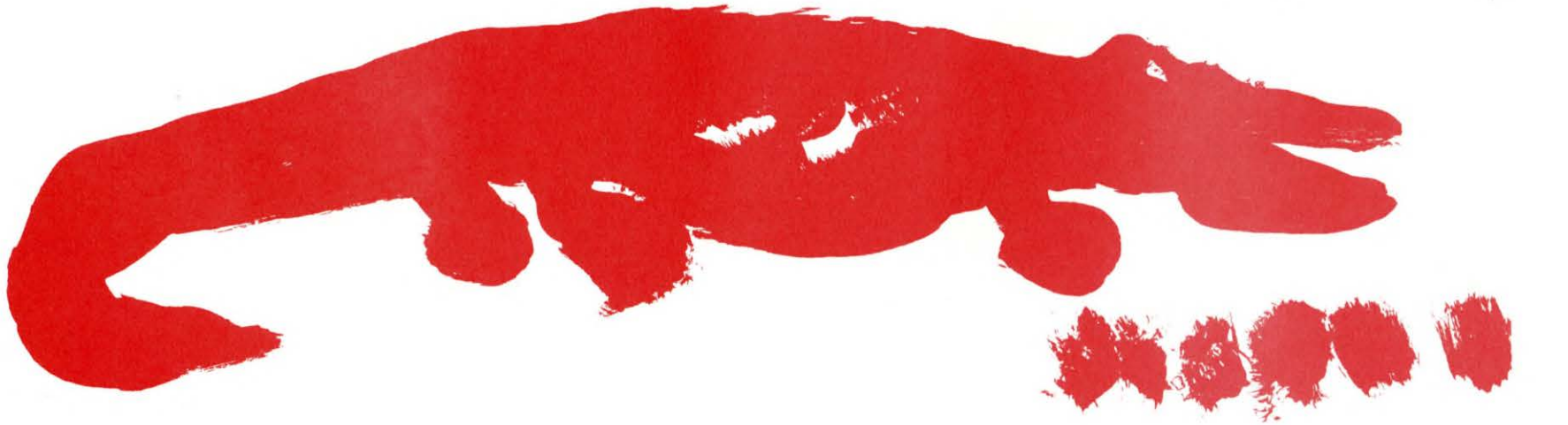
***Blue Tongue stayed out in  
the bush for a while***



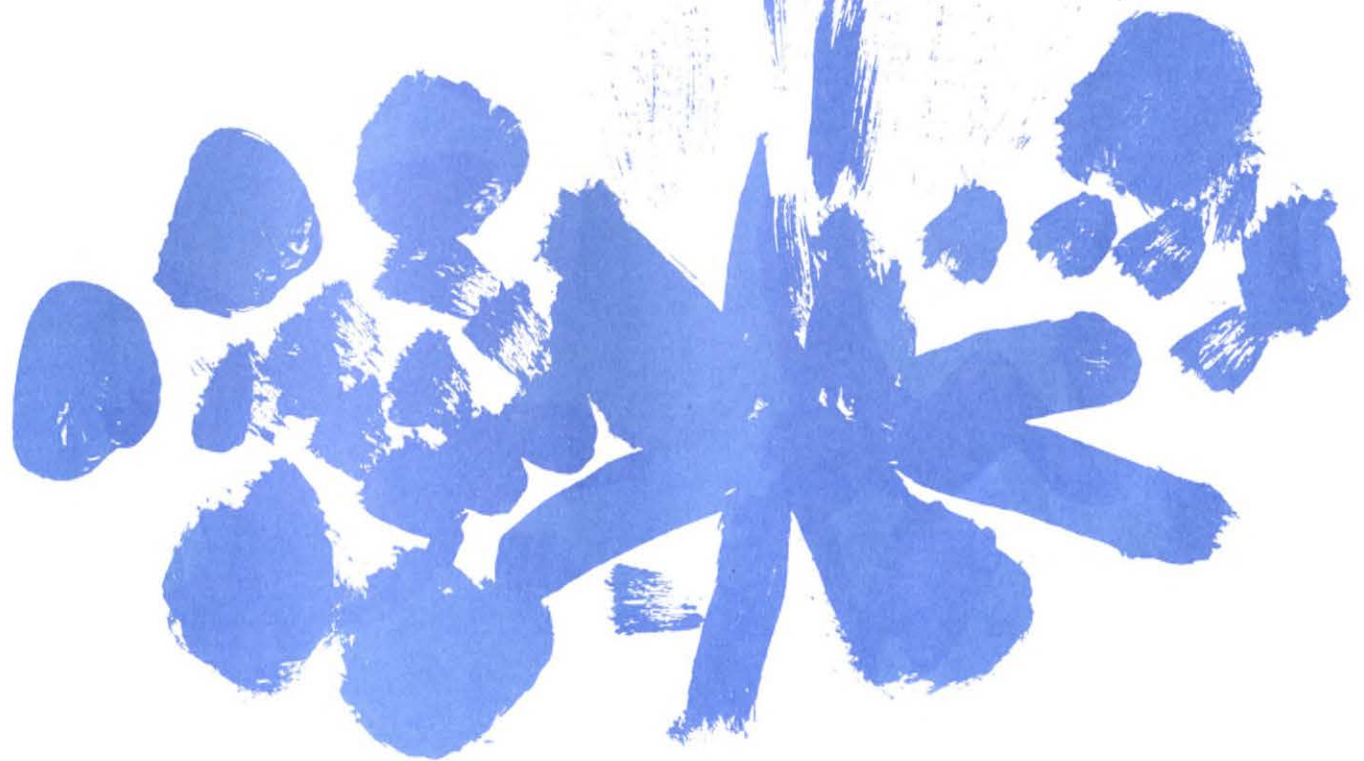
***Crocodile came back first.  
She went to her house but it was  
no good.  
“Let me go over to Blue Tongue’s  
house,” she said.***



***She went to Blue Tongue's house.***



***She was very happy there so she  
lay down and slept near the fire.***



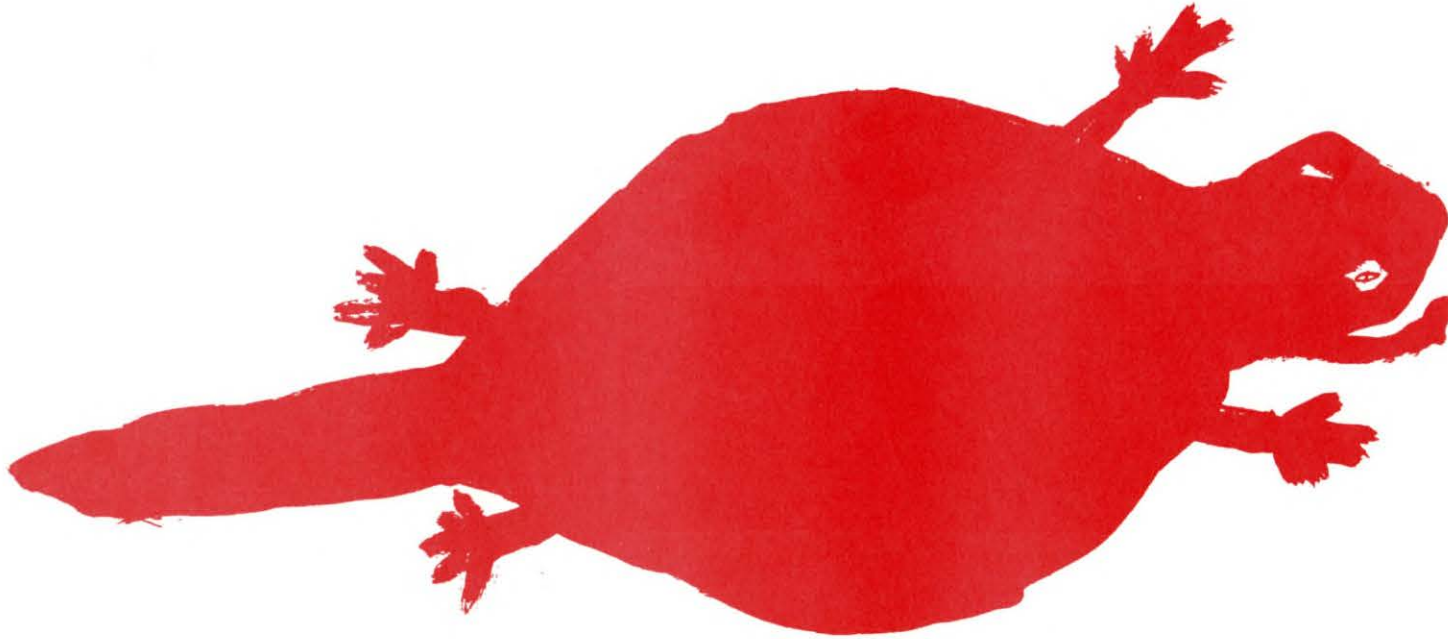


***Blue Tongue Lizard came home.  
She looked in Crocodile's house  
but Crocodile was not there.***





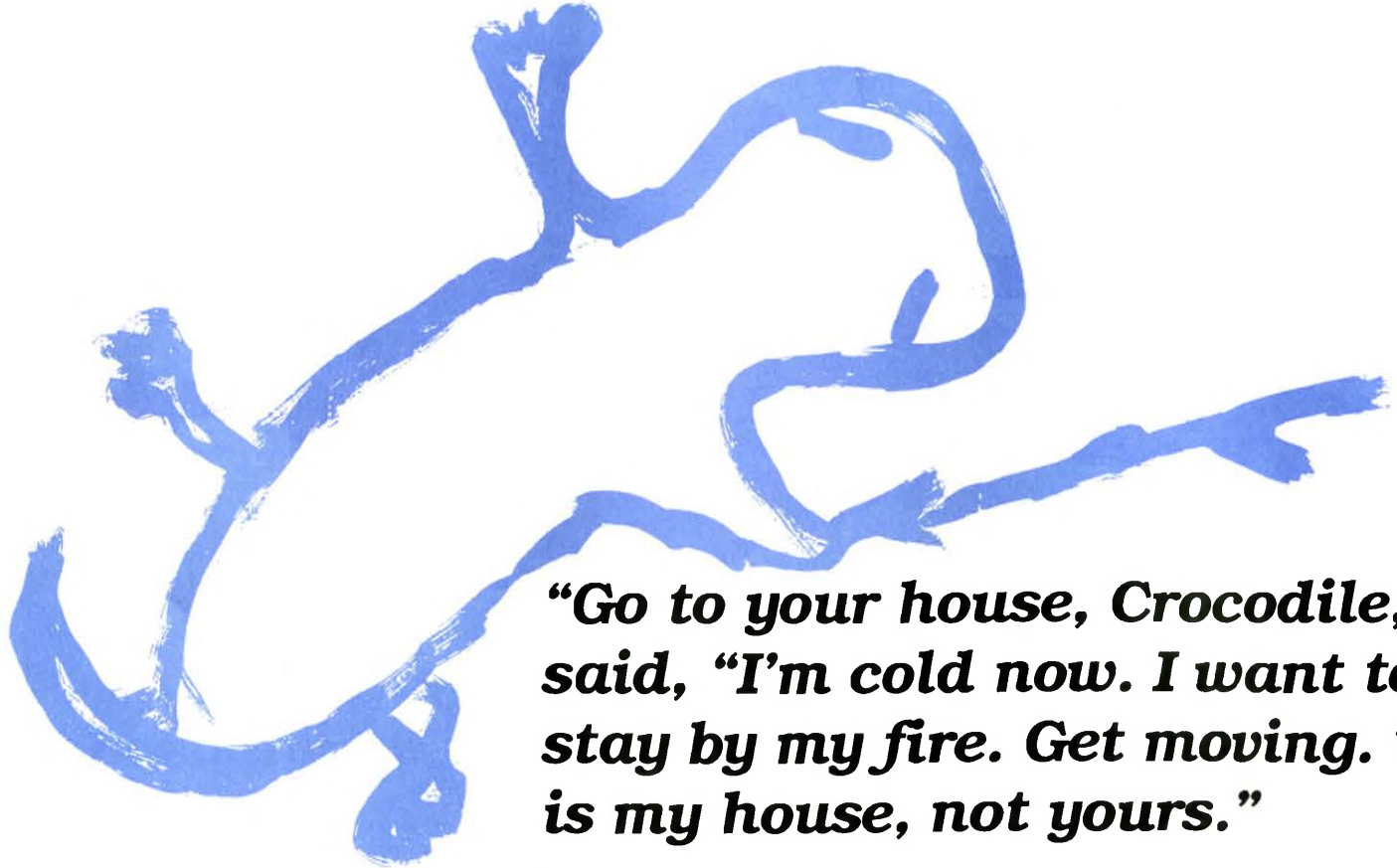
***She went to her house and there was Crocodile***



***“Wa! Dadija! Dadija! Get out,  
Crocodile,” she said. “This house is mine”***

**No way. Crocodile kept still and wouldn't listen.**

**Blue Tongue poked her all over,  
but Crocodile wouldn't move.**



**"Go to your house, Crocodile," she  
said, "I'm cold now. I want to  
stay by my fire. Get moving. This  
is my house, not yours."**

***Still Crocodile took no notice.***





**Blue Tongue had an idea. She got a baler shell and scooped up some hot coals and earth.**



**She picked up hot coals and threw them on Crocodile. She scooped them up and roasted Crocodile.**

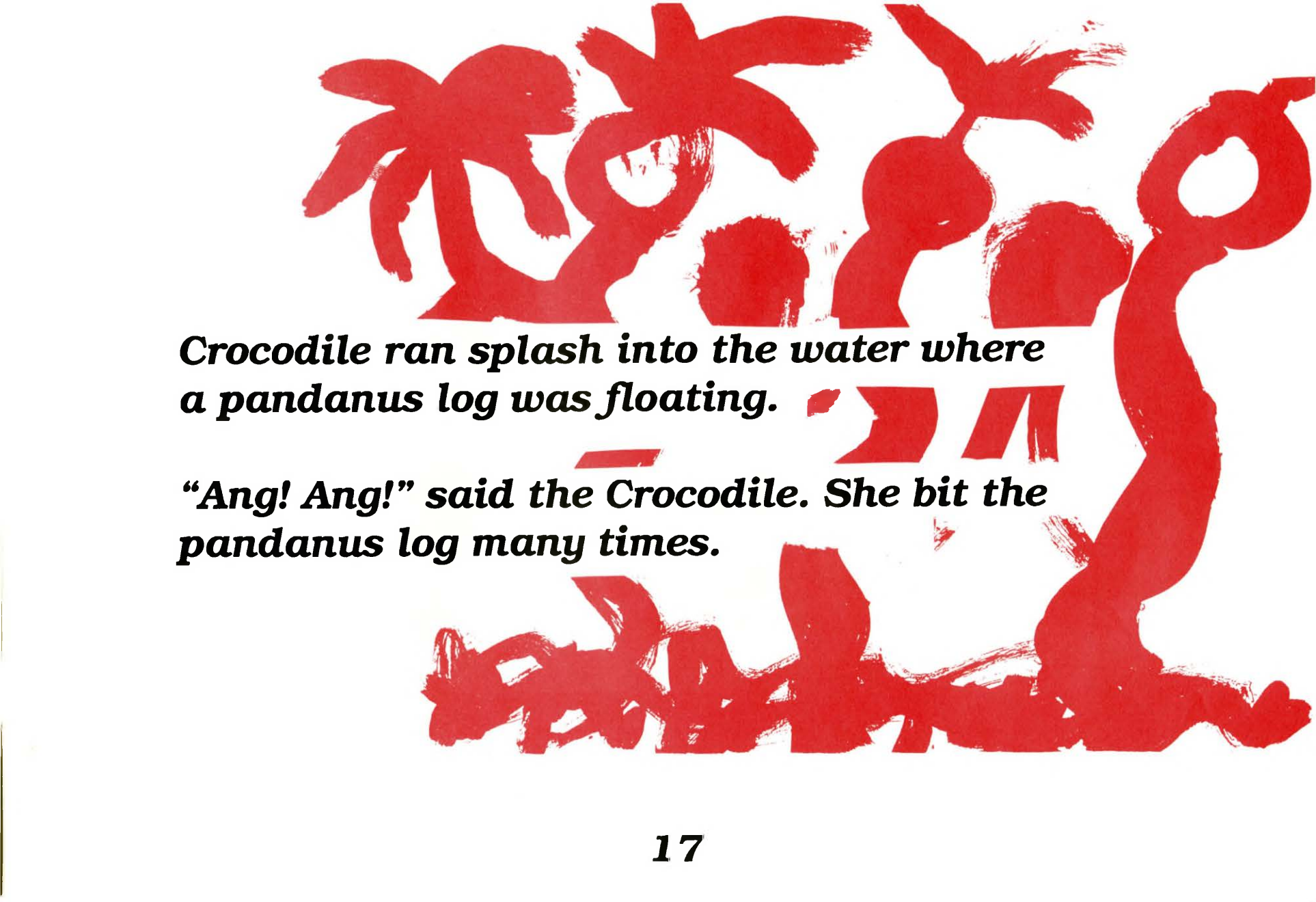
***“Ouch! Ouch! What are you doing to me,  
Blue Tongue?” cried Crocodile.***



***Blue Tongue didn't stop.  
She threw more coals on Crocodile.***







***Crocodile ran splash into the water where  
a pandanus log was floating.***

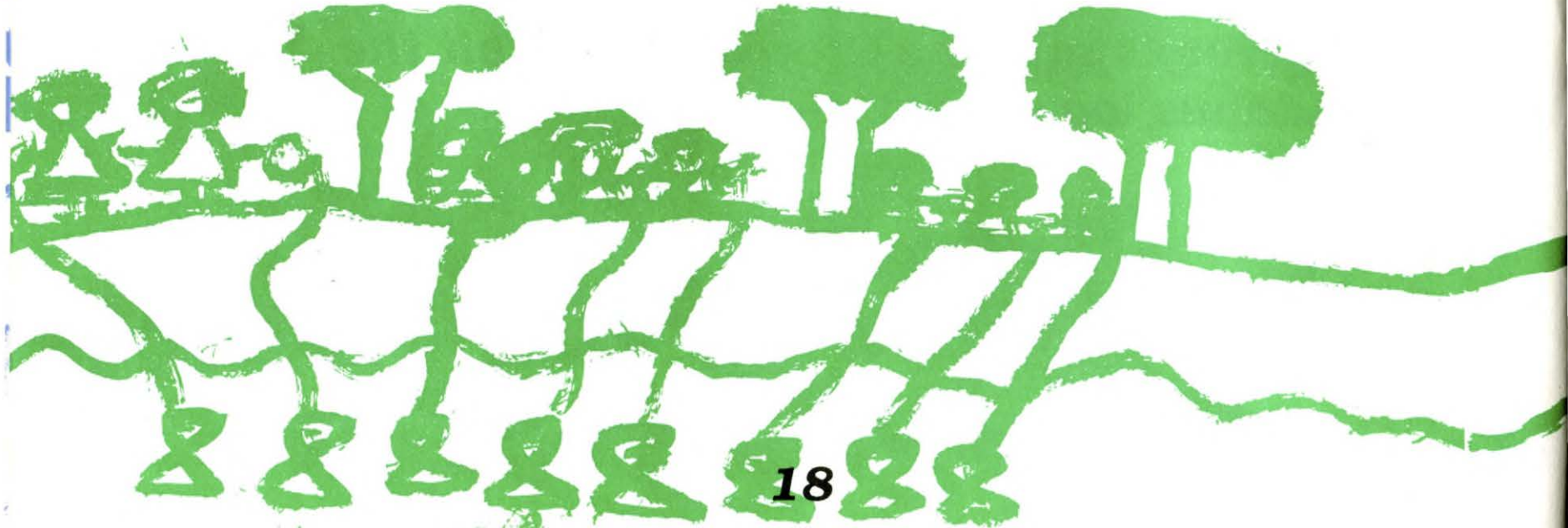
***“Ang! Ang!” said the Crocodile. She bit the  
pandanus log many times.***



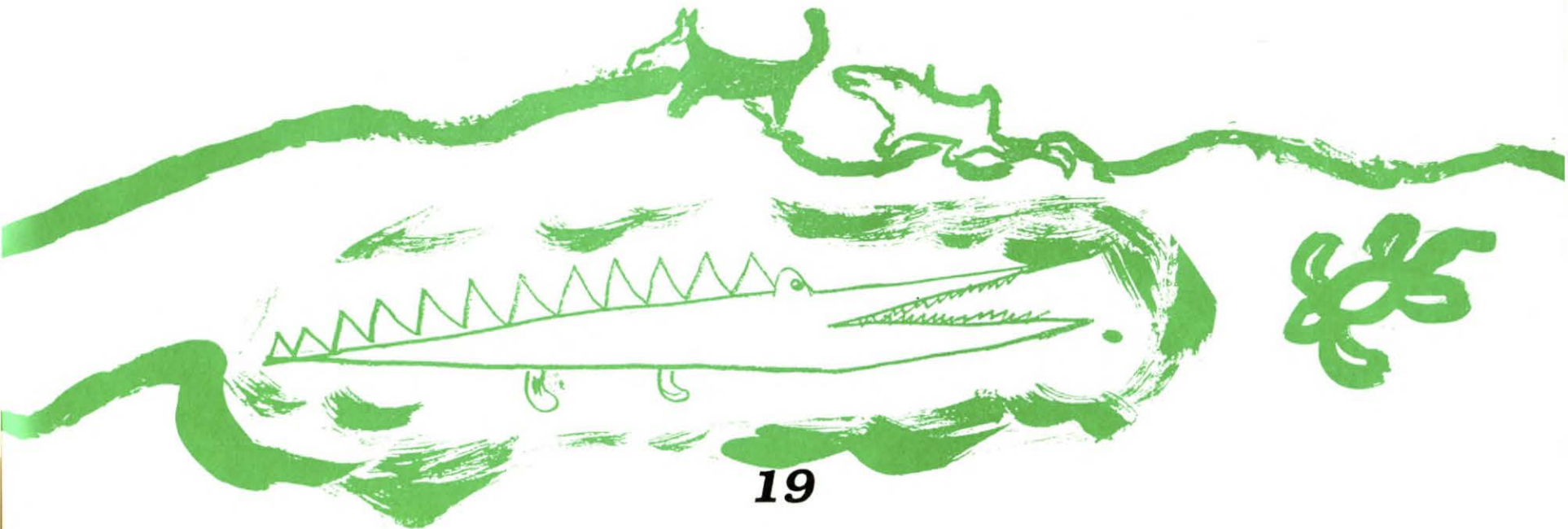


***“Ang! Ang! I will bite things. I will keep doing this. I will bite people. I will bite animals.***

***I will hide myself in the river and make myself quiet and float like a pandanus log, and then I will bite. Ang! Ang!”***



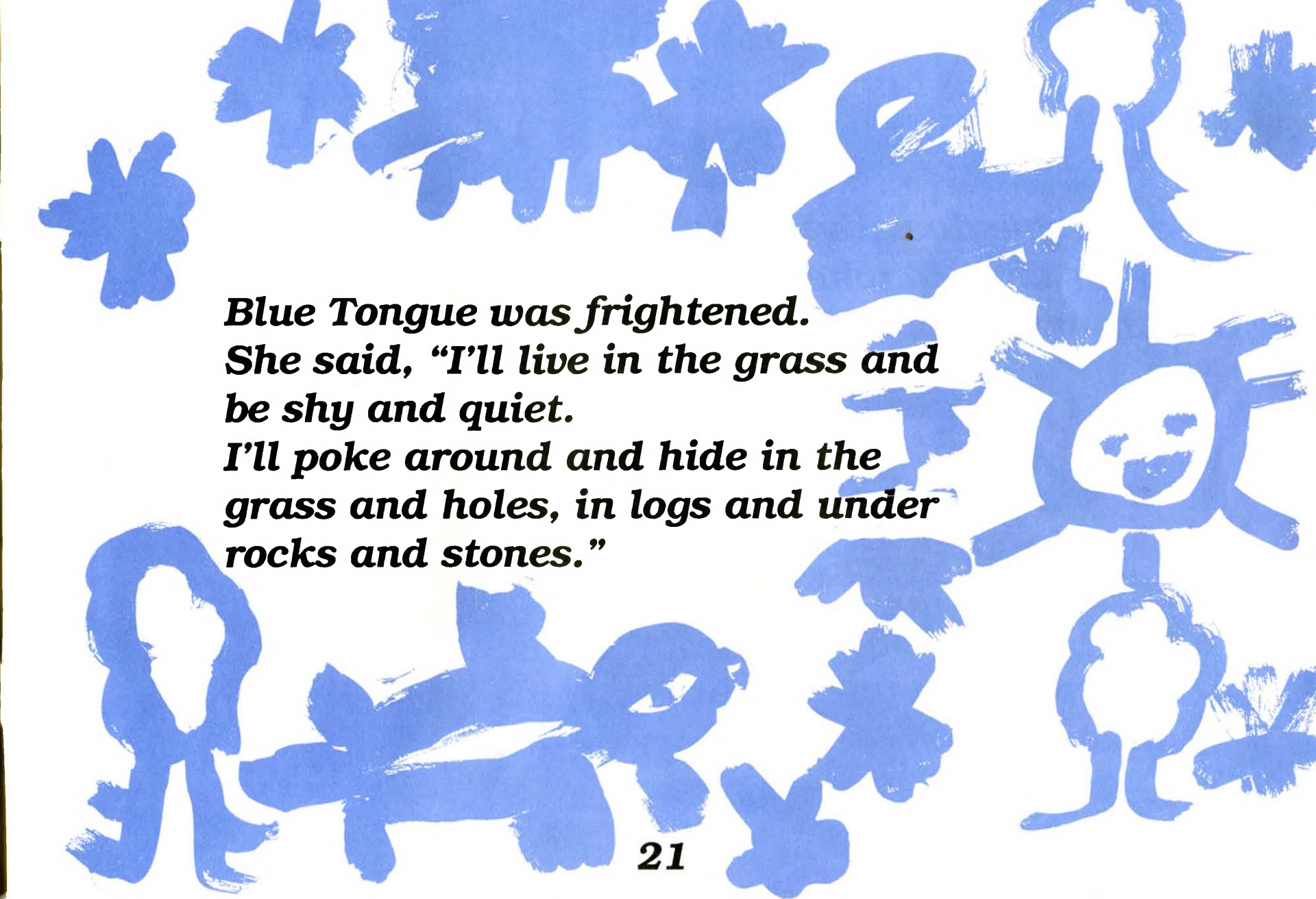
***“I will go into all the rivers and hide in the sea and be very greedy. I will bite all the people and all the animals and I won’t be ashamed,” she said. “Ang! Ang! Ang! Ang!”***



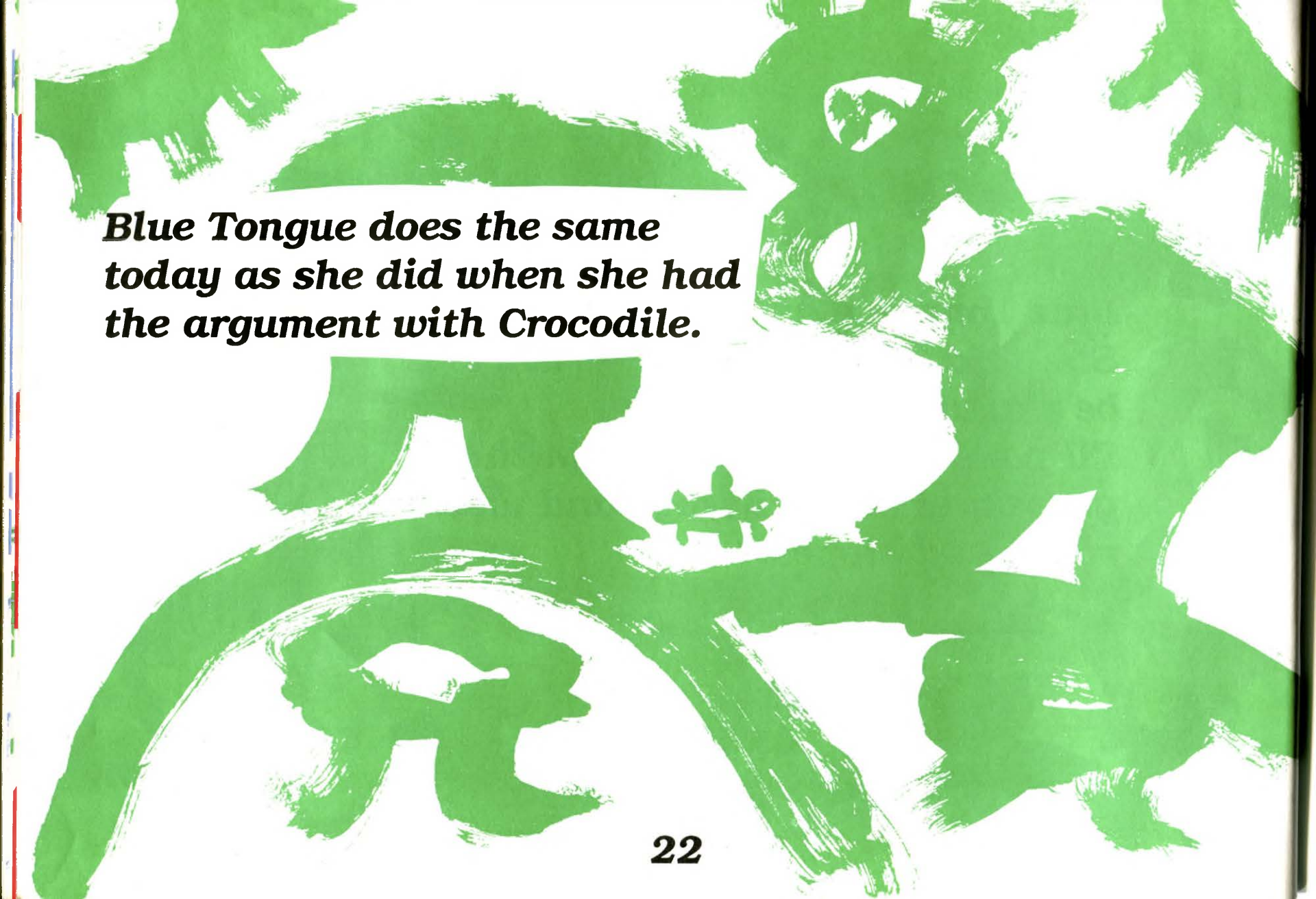






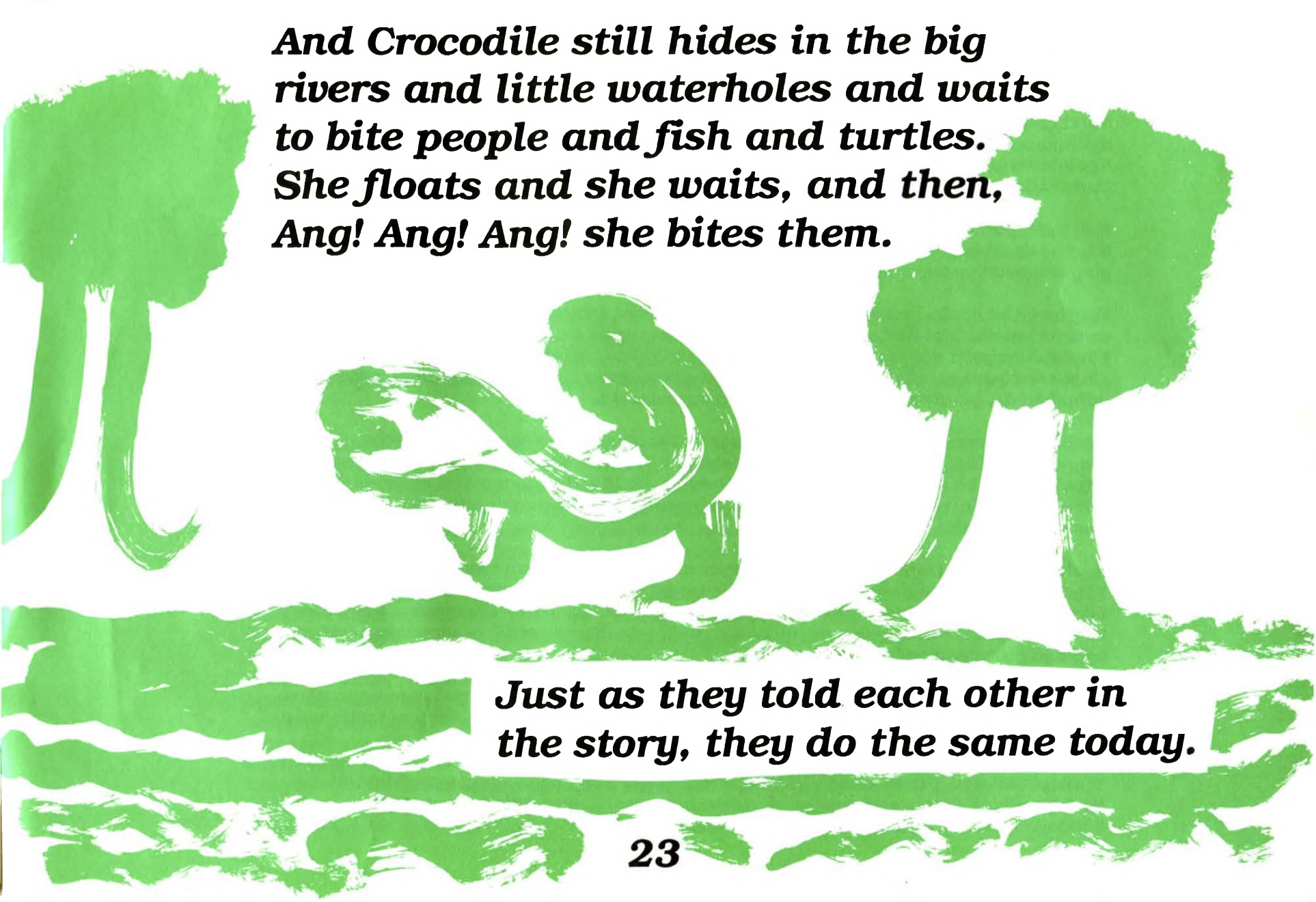


***Blue Tongue was frightened.  
She said, "I'll live in the grass and  
be shy and quiet.  
I'll poke around and hide in the  
grass and holes, in logs and under  
rocks and stones."***



***Blue Tongue does the same  
today as she did when she had  
the argument with Crocodile.***





***And Crocodile still hides in the big  
rivers and little waterholes and waits  
to bite people and fish and turtles.  
She floats and she waits, and then,  
Ang! Ang! Ang! she bites them.***

***Just as they told each other in  
the story, they do the same today.***



# **DINGARRBIYA-LANGWA AKWA YIMARNDAKUWABA-LANGWA**

*as told by Gula Lalara and Nabilia Lalara*

*recorded on tape by Judith Stokes in 1972 and written down by Dugururru Lalara*

*Narringi-ngekbungekburaka alikira wurringalakina Dingarrbiya akwa Dumarndakuwaba. Ngalaja mungkwa yelyukwa-da akwa narringi-ngekburakama alikira wurringalakina. Ngalaja Dingarrbiya yingi-likirakama alikira ngala-langwa. Umba ngalaja Dumarndakuwaba yingi-ngekburaka alikira akumarndakuwaba akina.*

*Narringi-ngurkwe-ne-ka eningiyakba-wa wurringalakina. Kembirra Dingarrbiya adinuba-wiya daka yingi-yar-da, umba ngalaja ambaka Dumarndakuwaba ying-ambubudinu-wiya, ying-ambambilyu-wiya ambaka.*

*Ying-awiyeba ngala-langwa-manja ebina alikira daka Dingarrbiya, bi...ya nara-da, awurrariya-da. "Ngi-likiya angerriba dadijarrka-langwu-wa," yingi-yama-da. Yingi-rukawiyeba dakina-langwa-manja, dadijadikba-langwa-manja. Arakba yingu-werringekburakajungwa ngawa yingu-werrungwur-da. Arakba yingu-murkwuluma adinakba-da, yingi-rakajuwa akina-manja angwura-da.*

*Ngalaje-ka Dumarnadakuwaba yingi-lawurradina. Yingi-alilikena. Biya akubina. Ying-andeya dadijadikba-wa bi...ya ardebirra alikira. Ying-andeya ngala-langwu-wa angalya. Arakba nang-akburranga. "Wa! Dadija! Dadija! Berra, angalya nganyangwa ena! Yirruminu-wadarrkiya nganja! Angaba alikira nungkwa-langwa nungkuwa!" yingi-yama Dumarndakuwaba.*

*Ngalaja nara-da. Yingu-mungkwulinga ngawa, ying-engkirrikena akena ying-erriminja-da. Yingi-yama kwureya nanga-murndakar-dirranga. Nare-ka. "Ningumurndade-ka arakba! Likiye-ka nungkwa-langwu-wa angalya arakba ningki-ngekburaka-murruwa, nungkwaja! Yeyebijeba yalakena angalya ngeniyerriya dadija-da. Berra kembirra yirruminu-wadarrkiya angalya yirra-langwa," yingi-yama.*

*Nara ngalaja-da. Kemba arakba yingi-yakuwerribika-da. Yingi-rndarrka yukwurna akwa yingini-kadirruwa abilyarringanda-manja amarnina akwa ajiringka. Yingini-kadirruwa akwa arakba nanga-karra-da.*

*"Yakayi! Yakayi! Ningki-yamarrkama dadija nganja ningkena," yingi-yama dakina. Ngalaja dibina Dumarndakuwaba ying-errikbina nanga-murndakidaka ngawa-da nanga-karranga-da nanga-warduwardemajuwe-ka.*

**Ying-angkarra akwa jalbur ying-alkingamba akungwa-manja. Numi-lyikbinuma ngalaja mangkurkwa. Ying-alkingamba akwa yingum-akburranga mangkurkwa mibina-da.**

**“Ang, ang, ki-yaminjaminamurra, k-angubanginamurra warnumamalya, yinungungwangba ang,” yingi-yama. Yinguma-murndangkingkarrngarnuma mibina mangkurkwa yingum-arrijakama-da.**

**“Ki-yaminjaminama adalyuma-manja k-akbakbujungwunamurra ki-nyanyarrngwukajungwunama ku-wurakiyirrmenamurra, k-ambambilyama adalyuma-manja ku-mijumijikeyinama karnumamalyu-wa akwa yinungungwangbu-wa ang, ang,” yingi-yama ngawa yinguma-lyamajuwama makina mangkurkwa yinguma-murndangkingkarrngarnuma akarrnga-ma-da.**

**“Ningumeringburre-ka ningenumamalya ningumijumija, ki-yaminjaminama eyukwayuwa-kba adalyuma, ku-mijumijikeyinama k-alilikajamurra, k-angubanginama karnumamalya, kin-angubanginama yinungungwangba. Ningumeringburre-ka ningenumamukiyeliya-ma,” yingi-yama dakina Dingarrbiya ngala.**

**Ngala Dumarndakuwaba yingi-yama, “Nganja ki-yaminjaminamurra, dadija, k-ambambilyama amarda-manja ningenikiyeliya ningenumamalya, k-awiyuwiyebea amardu-wa, ku-mijumijikeyinamurra, k-alkuwaytjinamurra, edirra-wa k-awiyebenama, k-alkuwaytjinama amarda-wa, k-alburrenamurra, ku-mijumijikeyinamurra ningenikiyeliya ningenumamalya ki-yaminjaminama ki-yeliyelenama ngawa,” yingi-yama ngala Dumarndakuwaba.**

**Yaka kamba aduwaba ngala Yimarndakuwaba ni-yaminama ngawa n-awiyebenama amarda-manja, edirra-manja, eka-manja, angwarnda-manja, malarra-manja. Ebina ayakwa wuburra ni-yengbinumurra akina aduwaba ni-yaminama yaka Yimarndakuwaba ngala numini-larmajungwunama ebinu-wa ayakwa ni-yama-murruwa nenumalawudawarra nangi-beyinu-murruwa Dingarrbiya dadijadikba. Ngalaujukwaba Dingarrbiya daka ngawa aduwaba yingi-yaminama arumuruma-kba adalyuma eyukwayuwa-kba adalyuma. Yingu-mijikeyinama yingu-wurakiyirrmenama, ying-akbujungwunamurra narring-anginama warnumamalya, narring-anginama wurruwarda, yinungungwangba, akwalya daka Dingarrbiya-da. Akina ngawa ayakwa ngawa, narringu-makijeyinuma akina ngawa wuburra aduwaba narringi-yaminama wurringalakena-da Dumarndakuwaba akwa Dingarrbiya-da. Akina-bu ngawa.**

